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The Dutch Defense for White

Fianchetto development against Leningrad, Stonewall, Classical, and anti-Dutch systems

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

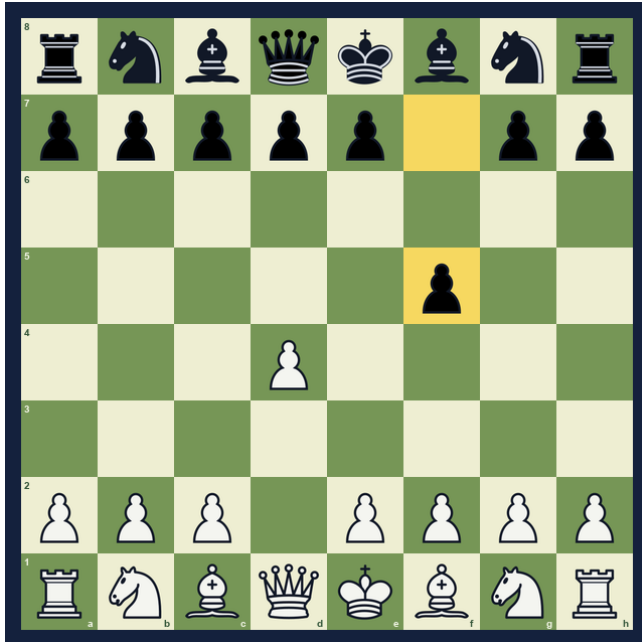
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
01 - Foundation	2
02 - Leningrad	2
03 - Stonewall	2
04 - Classical	2
05 - Anti-Dutch	6
06 - Fianchetto Systems	2
07 - Transpositions	2
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01. Dutch Core - Move Order



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Dutch Core structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White attacks e4, uses g3, or opens the center before Black castles.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 f5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch Core.

01. Decision Framework

Dutch Core - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

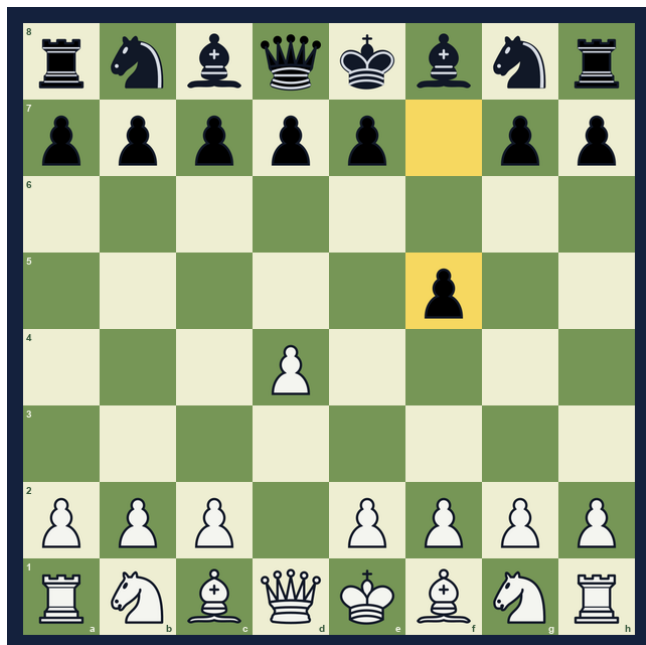
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch Core.

02. Dutch Core



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Black controls e4 and accepts a slight kingside loosening for an unbalanced fight.

PRIMARY PLAN

White attacks e4, uses g3, or opens the center before Black castles.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Develop quickly, secure the king, and choose a Leningrad, Stonewall, or Classical structure deliberately.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 f5

MEMORY RULE

The Dutch creates winning chances by controlling e4, but king safety is the price.

02. Decision Framework

Dutch Core

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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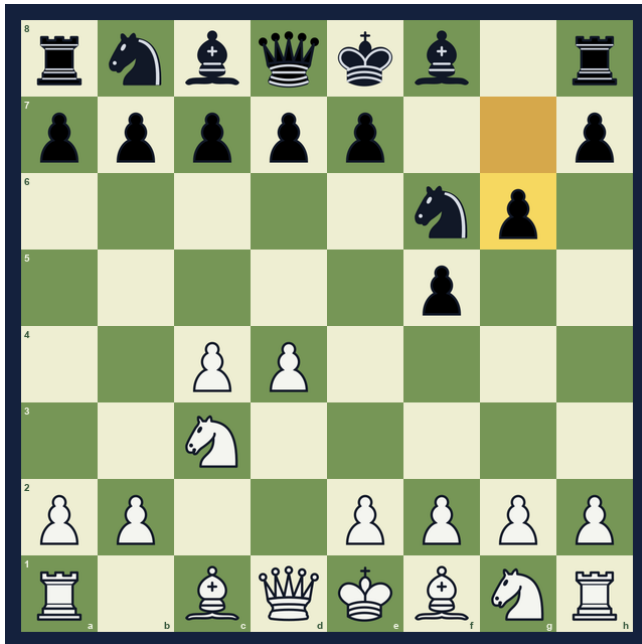
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Dutch creates winning chances by controlling e4, but king safety is the price.

03. Leningrad Dutch - Move Order



02 - Leningrad

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Leningrad Dutch structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses d5, e4, or queenside expansion to exploit dark squares.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Leningrad Dutch.

03. Decision Framework

Leningrad Dutch - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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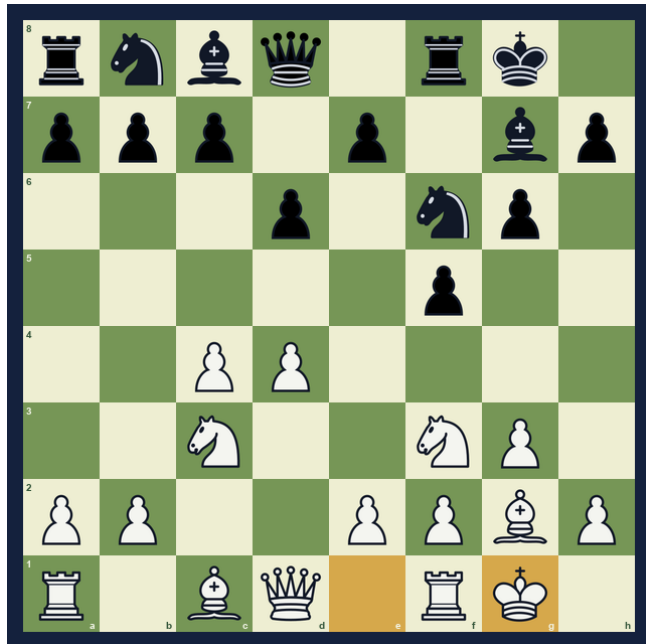
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Leningrad Dutch.

04. Leningrad Dutch



02 - Leningrad

READ THE POSITION

Black fianchettoes and prepares ...e5 while controlling e4.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses d5, e4, or queenside expansion to exploit dark squares.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Use ...e5 or ...c6 according to White's center and keep the king secure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 d6 7. O-O

MEMORY RULE

The Leningrad is active when ...e5 is prepared and the king is not exposed.

04. Decision Framework

Leningrad Dutch

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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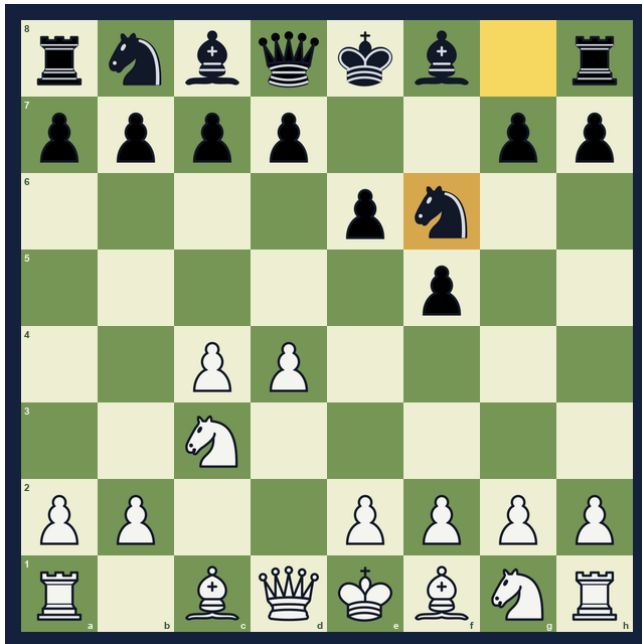
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Leningrad is active when ...e5 is prepared and the king is not exposed.

05. Stonewall Dutch - Move Order



03 - Stonewall

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Stonewall Dutch structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses Ne5, b3, Ba3, and queenside pressure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Stonewall Dutch.

05. Decision Framework

Stonewall Dutch - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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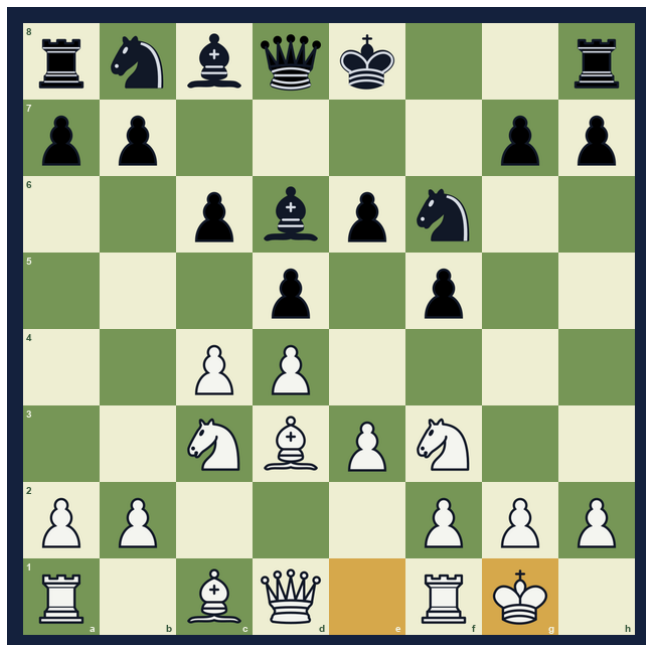
ACTIVE RECALL

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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Stonewall Dutch.

06. Stonewall Dutch



03 - Stonewall

READ THE POSITION

Black builds a fixed dark-square chain and gains e4 while conceding e5.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses Ne5, b3, Ba3, and queenside pressure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Place pieces for the locked structure and generate kingside play without weakening e6.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c6 5. e3 d5 6. Bd3 Bd6 7. O-O

MEMORY RULE

In the Stonewall, the e5 outpost and bad bishop must be managed before attacking.

06. Decision Framework

Stonewall Dutch

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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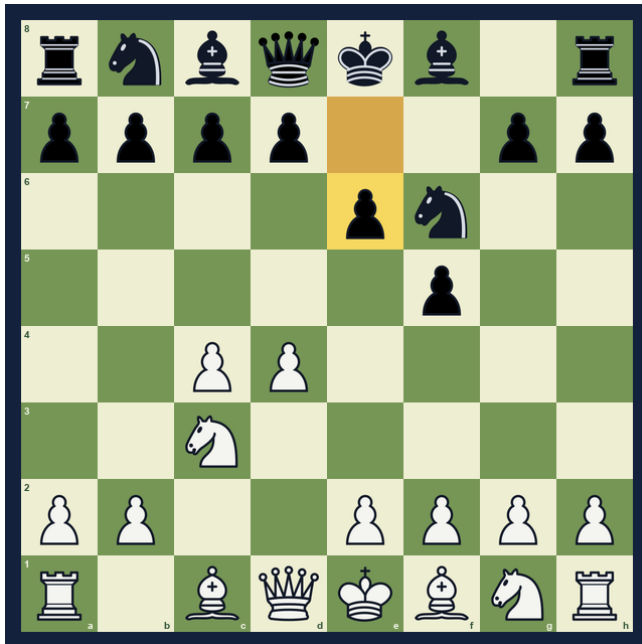
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In the Stonewall, the e5 outpost and bad bishop must be managed before attacking.

07. Classical Dutch - Move Order



04 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Classical Dutch structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses e4, d5, or queenside space.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 e6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical Dutch.

07. Decision Framework

Classical Dutch - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical Dutch.

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Black develops conventionally and keeps both ...e5 and ...d5 available.

White uses e4, d5, or queenside space.

Choose the central break from White's setup rather than drifting into a passive shell.

MEMORY RULE

Classical flexibility is useful only when it leads to a timely pawn break.

08. Decision Framework

Classical Dutch

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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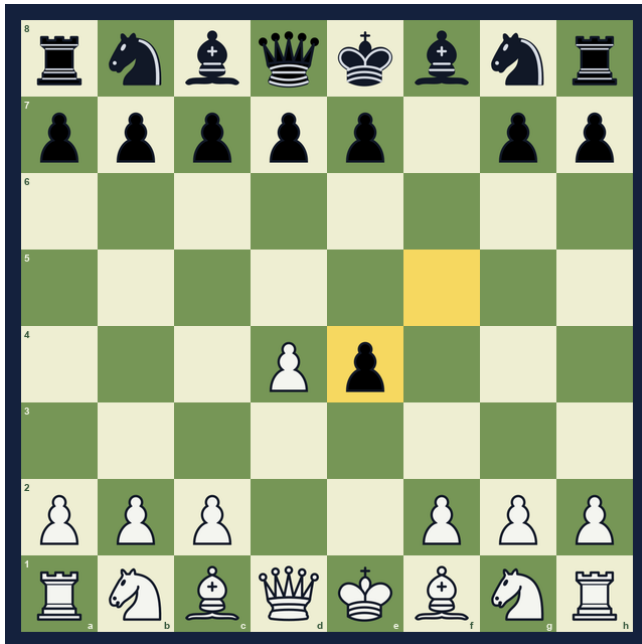
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Classical flexibility is useful only when it leads to a timely pawn break.

09. Staunton Gambit - Move Order



05 - Anti-Dutch

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Staunton Gambit structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses Qe2, O-O-O, and rapid piece activity.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 f5 2. e4 fxe4

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Staunton Gambit.

09. Decision Framework

Staunton Gambit - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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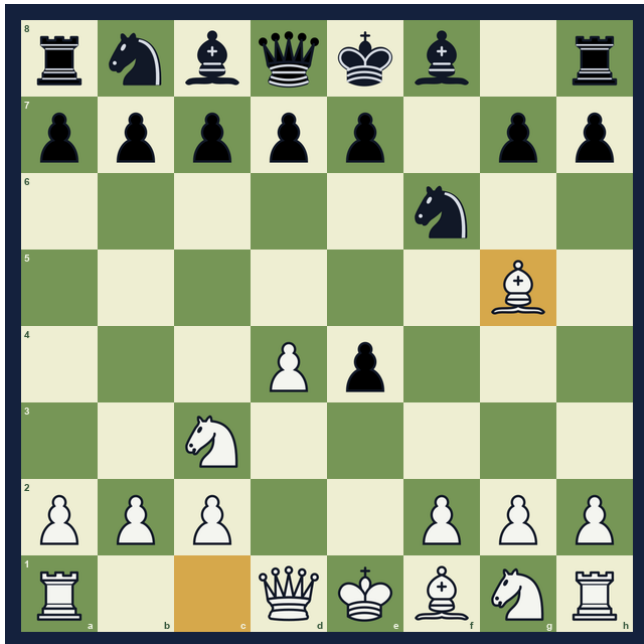
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Staunton Gambit.

10. Staunton Gambit



05 - Anti-Dutch

READ THE POSITION

White sacrifices a pawn for development and pressure on e4 and the king.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses Qe2, O-O-O, and rapid piece activity.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Return material if needed, complete development, and neutralize the pin before expanding.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 f5 2. e4 fxe4 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5

MEMORY RULE

Against the Staunton, development and king safety outrank holding the extra pawn.

10. Decision Framework

Staunton Gambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
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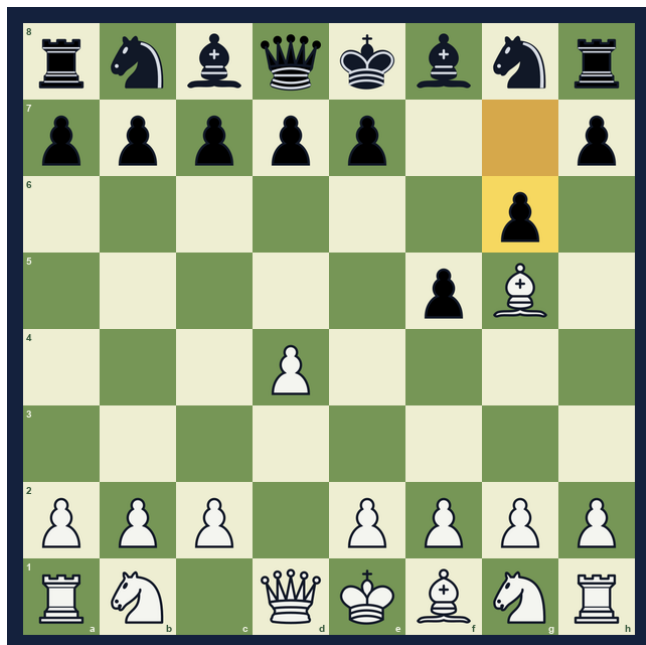
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Staunton, development and king safety outrank holding the extra pawn.

11. Dutch 2.Bg5 - Move Order



05 - Anti-Dutch

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Dutch 2.Bg5 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses e4 and queenside development to exploit the move order.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. Bg5 g6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch 2.Bg5.

11. Decision Framework

Dutch 2.Bg5 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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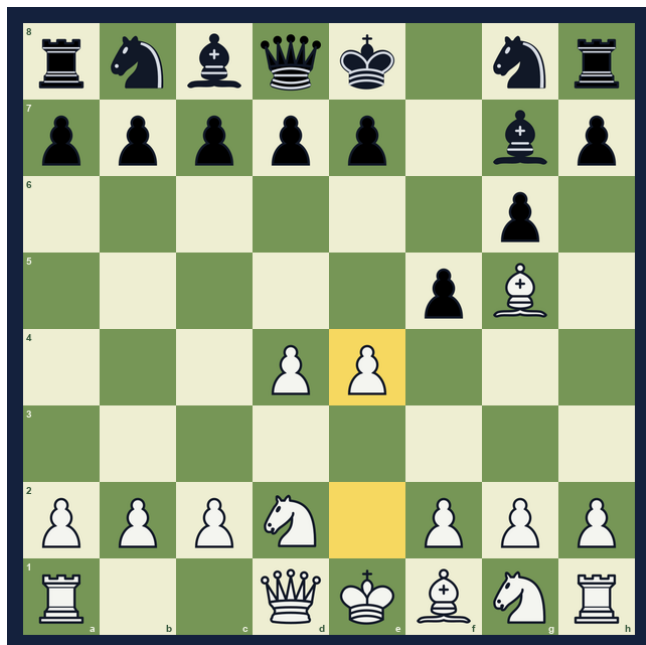
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch 2.Bg5.

12. Dutch 2.Bg5



05 - Anti-Dutch

READ THE POSITION

White questions the f-pawn and builds e4 before Black completes development.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses e4 and queenside development to exploit the move order.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Challenge the bishop and strike at the center without weakening the dark squares further.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. Bg5 g6 3. Nd2 Bg7 4. e4

MEMORY RULE

Anti-Dutch systems punish automatic setups; answer the concrete center.

12. Decision Framework

Dutch 2.Bg5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Anti-Dutch systems punish automatic setups; answer the concrete center.

13. Dutch 2.Nc3 - Move Order



05 - Anti-Dutch

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Dutch 2.Nc3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses f3 and e4 to seize the center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. Nc3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch 2.Nc3.

13. Decision Framework

Dutch 2.Nc3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

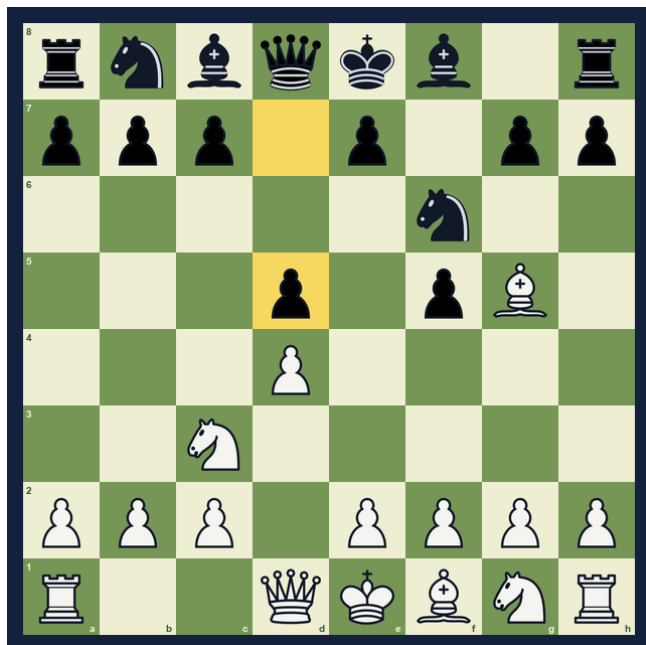
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch 2.Nc3.

14. Dutch 2.Nc3



05 - Anti-Dutch

READ THE POSITION

White prepares e4 and develops the bishop outside the pawn chain.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses f3 and e4 to seize the center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Control e4, develop quickly, and avoid a passive blockade.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. Bg5 d5

MEMORY RULE

The e4-square is the Dutch's central promise; defend it with pieces, not hope.

14. Decision Framework

Dutch 2.Nc3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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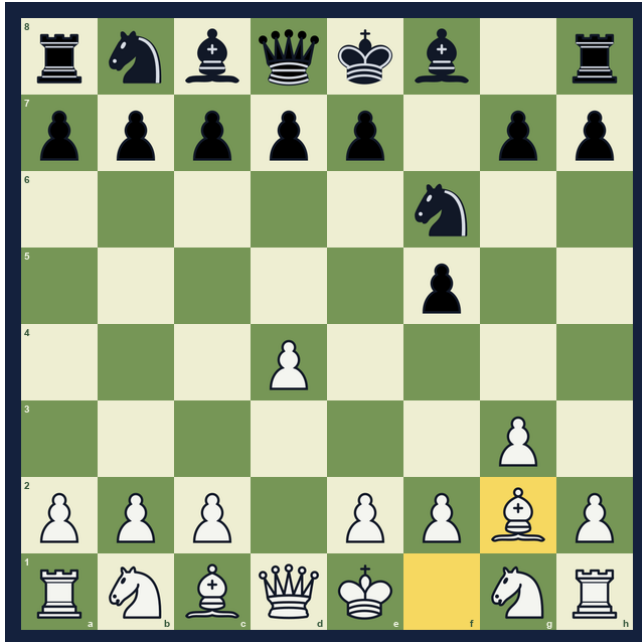
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The e4-square is the Dutch's central promise; defend it with pieces, not hope.

15. White Fianchetto - Move Order



06 - Fianchetto Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the White Fianchetto structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses c4, d5, and queenside pressure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward White Fianchetto.

15. Decision Framework

White Fianchetto - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward White Fianchetto.

16. White Fianchetto



06 - Fianchetto Systems

READ THE POSITION

Both sides fianchetto and prepare competing central breaks.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses c4, d5, and queenside pressure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Use ...d6 and ...e5 while preventing an uncontested d5 advance.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. O-O O-O

MEMORY RULE

In mirrored diagonals, the pawn break determines which bishop matters.

16. Decision Framework

White Fianchetto

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In mirrored diagonals, the pawn break determines which bishop matters.

17. English Move Order - Move Order



07 - Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

Reach the English Move Order structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White may use e4 or d4 under favorable conditions.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 f5 2. Nc3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Move Order.

17. Decision Framework

English Move Order - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Move Order.

18. English Move Order



07 - Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

The Dutch structure arises against the English without an early d-pawn commitment.

PRIMARY PLAN

White may use e4 or d4 under favorable conditions.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Preserve flexibility and decide whether ...e5 or ...d6 fits White's setup.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 f5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7

MEMORY RULE

Recognize the e4-control theme even when the opening label changes.

18. Decision Framework

English Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Recognize the e4-control theme even when the opening label changes.

19. Dutch with Nh3 - Move Order



08 - Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Dutch with Nh3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses Nf4 and c4 to challenge e6 and d5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 f5 2. Nh3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch with Nh3.

19. Decision Framework

Dutch with Nh3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

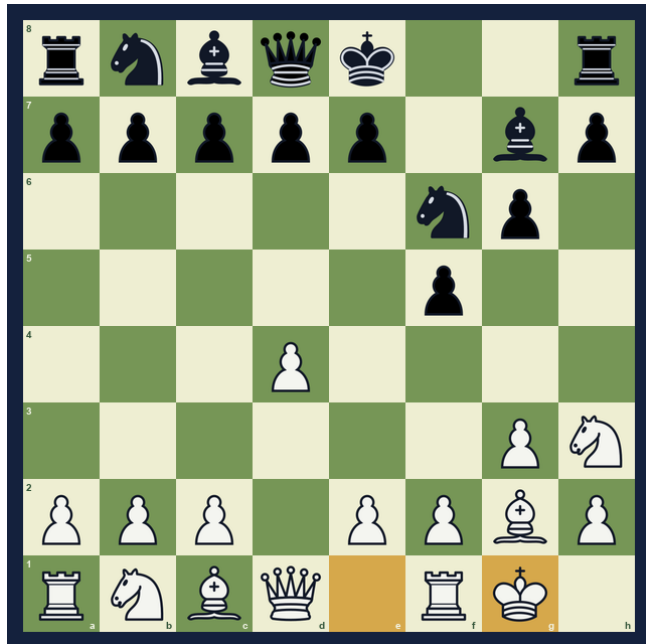
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Dutch with Nh3.

20. Dutch with Nh3



08 - Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

White develops the knight toward f4 and avoids early pins.

PRIMARY PLAN

White uses Nf4 and c4 to challenge e6 and d5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Build the center, watch Nf4 pressure, and prepare ...e5 without weakening the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. Nh3 Nf6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Unusual knight routes still attack familiar structural targets.

20. Decision Framework

Dutch with Nh3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Unusual knight routes still attack familiar structural targets.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.